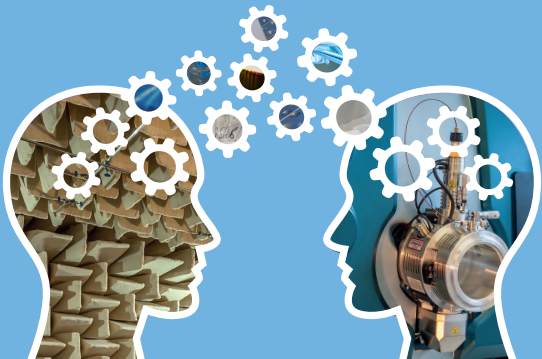


CONSULT

User Guide



What is CONSULT?

CONSULT is the University's online approval and facilitation system, which streamlines the support process for when you're working with external organisations on consultancy projects, or providing facilities & equipment-related services.

CONSULT:

- Automates requests for project approval
- Gives access to Professional Services support for costing projects and obtaining pricing advice
- Initiates the contract process
- Allows reporting and recognition

Access CONSULT at: www.liverpool.ac.uk/consult

Log in using your University username and password (MWS). If you experience any technical difficulties with CONSULT please contact CSD Service Desk.

Getting started

Once you've logged in you'll be taken to the main menu, from here you can:

- Create new project applications
- View current applications and check their progress
- See completed applications and view associated contracts
- Where applicable, approve and view projects within your area

Institutional Project Application Overview



Initiation

From the 'Main Menu' select 'Create new application' and 'Apply now' under institutional project. You then enter details related to the project and submit for costing.



Costing and Credit Check

Projects are costed and the external organisation is credit checked by Professional Services teams. You will be notified by email when this is completed.



Approval Request

Log in to CONSULT, enter final project details and submit for approval.



Approval

Each person's Approver will be notified to approve their involvement in the project.



Contract Set-Up

Consultancy Team will work with you to get the necessary documentation in place.



Invoicing

Your local Research & Finance team will be responsible for invoicing the external organisation in due course for payment.

Institutional Projects

When work is being conducted through the University

These projects benefit from the support of Professional Services teams, as well as being covered by University insurance.

As an applicant  there are 2 steps you need to complete: Initiation and Approval Request as shown in the previous overview and described below.



Initiation

During Initiation you input information related to the project including:

- Details of the external organisation you will be working with
- All University staff members & postgraduate students contributing to the work
- An accurate estimation of time commitment

Only you as the applicant can make changes to the project details, however, anyone recorded as contributing will receive notification and can also view project details.

You must select  in order to progress your application through the process. Your local Research & Finance team will then cost the project and you will be notified to complete the second stage 'Approval Request'.



Approval Request

Once costing & credit check are complete you will receive an email notification and can log in to CONSULT to see this information. You must then complete some final details under the 'Approval Request' tab related to the price you will charge for the work and whether you would like any associated income to be kept in a cost-center, paid through payroll or a mix of the two.

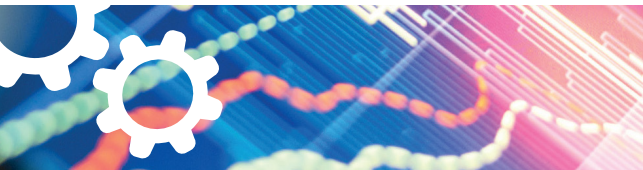
You also need to upload a work programme, project plan or any other relevant documentation before submitting the application for approval.

✓ Submit for approval

Project Approval

Each member of staff needs **approval** to be involved in the project - an automated email is sent to the appropriate Level 1 or 2 Head asking them to review project details and either grant or withhold approval.

If prior approval has been given in advance, a 'for information only' email is sent to the Approver, with no action needed from them unless they want to raise any concerns.



Private Projects

When work is being conducted in a personal capacity



These projects will be carried out **independently** from the University in a personal capacity, with the staff member involved being personally liable for the work and responsible for contracting directly with the external organisation. Professional Services support will not be provided and income will not be brought into the University.



Approval Request

If you create a private application you will be asked to confirm acceptance of the conditions to carry out work on a private basis. You will then input information about the project and must submit for approval. You will be notified once your Approver has actioned this and your application will be complete.

Good to know...

From the 'Main Menu', clicking on  **View your CONSULT profile** allows you to see details of your Research & Finance team and your project Approver.

Helpful  buttons are included throughout providing additional information.

While working on an application you can:

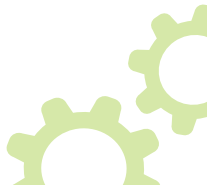
 **Submit for action**

 **Save changes**

 **Exit without saving**

Tabs across the top of an application allow you to see every stage of the process and associated details.

Each application is given its own unique CONSULT reference number which follows the project throughout the process.



How can I change details of my application?

CONSULT applications can be amended without the need to cancel or create a new one.

If your application is in the process of being costed & credit checked or is waiting for approval you can chose to **Unlock & edit** - as a consequence it will return to the stage you have chosen to edit. e.g if you edit details within the initiation stage after costings have been completed the application will have to be submitted through that stage again.

What if my application isn't given approval?

If this occurs you will receive email notification and may wish to discuss with your Approver reasons why approval was not granted. They may suggest changes that would make the project suitable and in this case you can edit the application and re-submit it for approval. If the project is no longer going ahead you can cancel the application.





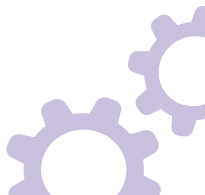
Approving Projects

If you have line management responsibilities or are a Level 1 or 2 head you may receive an “Approval Request” email from CONSULT to approve an individual’s involvement in a project. It is important that these requests are reviewed and actioned as soon as possible, flagging up any concerns you might have.

To help you do this, the email will include a link to CONSULT - simply log in to see all the project information and you can select approval ‘granted’ or ‘withheld’.

If a staff member has prior-approval you will still be notified and although no action is needed it is good practice to log in and check the project details, and if necessary raise any concerns you might have.

You can log in to CONSULT at any time to see projects that currently require approval and view details of all projects that you have previously been notified of or asked to approve.



Consultancy Team Support

Business Gateway

The team provides dedicated and tailored support for your consultancy or facility & equipment service projects and can:

- Help with project planning including defining project scope and deliverables
- Advise on the price you should charge and market rates
- Liaise directly with external organisations on your behalf
- Carry out legal review of terms & conditions and negotiate all aspects of contracts
- Help protect academic interests and reduce any potential risks
- Assist with service-related tender applications
- Develop marketing material to promote your area of expertise or specialist facilities
- Channel potential business opportunities

Contact Us

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